



administration were all emulated, and Japan was able to modernize rapidly by adopting European ideas (see pp.356–57). However, despite being of European descent, the Boers of South Africa moved into the Natal, Orange Free State, and Transvaal regions of the country, so eager were they to escape British rule (see p.361). By 1900, much of the inhabited world was governed, directly or indirectly, by Europeans, or those of European descent.

Deportation

By the mid-19th century, the French government reduced prison costs by sending “undesirables” to their far-off colonies. This woodcut depicts the deportation of prisoners from Toulon to Cayenne on the steamboat *Ceres*.

After World War II, most colonies were granted, or won their independence. Today, only a few remnants of the great colonial powers survive.

THE END OF COLONIALISM

Portuguese possessions were some of the last colonies to become independent **412–13** >>. In North and South America and Australia, **European rule left a permanent stamp.** In China, it left scarcely a trace.

AFRICA

Africans increasingly gained independence after World War II **392–405** >>, but economic difficulties often caused **political instability** in the new nations. This often led to dictatorships—by 1976, 21 African countries had military governments.

AFRICAN IMMIGRATION TO EUROPE

Economic and political development failures in Africa, and new immigration and refugee policies in Europe, saw **mass migration** by African

peoples. Between 1960–89 an estimated 70,000–100,000 highly skilled African workers went to Europe, but they often faced discrimination.

INDIGENOUS PEOPLES

Indigenous peoples such as the forest people of the Amazon, the tribal people of India, and the Inuit of the Arctic **lost their land** during colonization. There is still a threat of territorial invasion, and the plundering of resources, in these places.

AFTER >>